



PunkBackup — Installation Manual

This manual shows the app in **English**. It opens in Spanish by default the very first time — go to **"Settings"** → **"English"** and everything switches instantly (no restart). Your choice is remembered after that.

What this system does

Automatically backs up photos and videos from one or more iPhones/iPads to your Windows PC, over local WiFi, no cable, no iCloud dependency. Each person/device gets its own profile with its own destination folder.

Important: this app is not code-signed

PunkBackup is a small independent project — the `.exe` is **not** digitally signed with a paid code-signing certificate (those cost money; see the project's notes on this if you're curious why). This has two real, expected consequences:

- **Windows SmartScreen** will warn you once at install time (see Step 2). This is normal and harmless — click through it as described below.
- **Your antivirus may go further than a warning.** Antivirus products use heuristics (behavior patterns), not just known-virus lists, and an unsigned new program that talks to the network can trip those heuristics — even though PunkBackup only talks to your own iPhone on your own WiFi and never sends anything anywhere else. **Avast in particular has been observed silently closing PunkBackup shortly after it opens**, with no error message from the app itself (it just vanishes). If that happens to you, it's Avast, not a bug in PunkBackup — see the fix below.

You can read the full source code yourself (this is an open-source project) if you want to verify exactly what it does before trusting it.

Fixing "Avast keeps closing the app"

1. Open **Avast** → **Menu** → **Quarantine** (or "Virus Chest") — if `PunkBackup.exe` is listed there, restore it and add an exception so it doesn't get grabbed again.
2. Or: **Avast** → **Menu** → **Settings** → **General** → **Exceptions** → add the install folder (default `C:\Program Files\PunkBackup\`) so Avast skips scanning/blocking it entirely.
3. Reopen PunkBackup from the Desktop icon — it should now stay open.

This is the same fix for other antivirus products that behave this way (Windows Defender, Norton, etc.) — add an exception for the PunkBackup install folder.

Requirements

- **Windows 10 or 11** PC.
- **Internet** connection (only to download the installer).
- The iPhone/iPad and the PC must be able to reach the **same WiFi network** at backup time.
- **Administrator** rights on the PC (asked once, during install — to copy the program and add the Firewall rule).

Step 1 — Download the installer

Download PunkBackupSetup.exe from the project's release page:

<https://github.com/hesner/punkbackup/releases/latest>

Step 2 — Run the installer

1. Double-click `PunkBackupSetup.exe`.
2. Windows may show a **SmartScreen** warning ("Windows protected your PC") since this is a new program without a paid code-signing certificate — click **"More info"** → **"Run anyway"**.
3. Accept the **User Account Control (UAC)** prompt — the installer needs admin rights to copy the program into `Program Files` and to add the Firewall rule.
4. If your antivirus scans the file (e.g. Avast, "Suspicious file detected" / reputation scan), that's normal for a brand-new installer — let it finish, it shouldn't find anything.
5. Follow the wizard: - Pick the setup language (this does **not** set the app's language — the app has its own ES/EN switch in "Settings"). - Keep **"Create a desktop icon"** checked to get the Desktop shortcut. - Keep the **Firewall rule** task checked (recommended — if you skip it, you'll need to add it manually later for your iPhone to connect). - Click **Install** and wait for it to finish.
6. At the end, leave "Launch PunkBackup" checked and click **Finish** — the app opens on its own.

Step 3 — First launch

1. The app opens (dark window, two screens: "Main" and "Settings"), in Spanish by default — switch it to English per the note at the top of this manual, if you haven't already.
2. Go to **"Settings"** → click **"+ Add profile"** → name your device (e.g. "iPhone de [your name]") → pick the folder where you want your photos saved.
3. Go to **"Main"** → click **"Start backup"**.
4. If you didn't check the Firewall task during install, Windows may show the prompt here instead asking to allow the connection — accept it, checking at least **"Private networks"**.
5. It should say **"Status: Listening on port 8787"**.

Step 4 — Set up your iPhone

Follow the separate **iPhone Setup Manual** to create the Shortcut and, optionally, the WiFi automation.

Is it working?

- Check "**Settings**" shows your profile with its destination folder.
- Run the Shortcut once on your iPhone as a test.
- Check the folder you chose — you should see Year/Month subfolders with your photos inside.

If something's not working, see the **Troubleshooting Manual**.